Dominic Le

Contact
+1 (778) 887-6799
dominic.le@mail.utoronto.ca

dominicle.net
github.com/dominictle

Research Interests

Causal and counterfactual cognition, cognitive development, computational cognitive science, learning, memory, philosophy of language, philosophy of cognitive science.

Education

M.A. Developmental Psychology and Education. 2026 – 2027
University of Toronto.
Supervisor: Patricia Ganea.

H.B.Sc. Psychology and Cognitive Science, *High Distinction.* 2022 – 2026
University of Toronto.

Peer-reviewed Publications

Proceedings

Le, D., & Mekik, C. (2026). *A Spreading Activation Model of Causal Reasoning.* Proceedings of the 24th International Conference on Cognitive Modeling. Forthcoming.

Grosu, I., **Le, D.**, & Ganea, P. (2025). *Backwards Counterfactuals and the Closest Possible World.* Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, 47.

Software

Dercon, Q., Harsch, R., **Le, D.**, Yasuda, S., Chang, C., & Struhl, M. (2025). *snap-sort* (Version 1.0.0) [Software]. jsPsych-contrib.
https://github.com/dominictle/jspsych-contrib-contrib/tree/plugin-snap-sort

Conferences & Presentations

Refereed

Le, D., & Mekik, C. (2026). *A Spreading Activation Model of Causal Reasoning.* Talk to be presented at the International Conference on Cognitive Modeling (ICCM, July), Montreal, QC. Poster presented at the Annual Meeting of the Canadian Society for Brain, Behaviour and Cognitive Science (CSBBCS, June), North York, ON.

Le, D., Grosu, I., & Ganea, P. (2026, April). *Children's Backward Counterfactual Logic.* Poster presented at the Biennial Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society (CDS), Montreal, QC.

Le, D. (2025). *Causal Stacks: A Structural Framework for Recurrent and Hierarchical Counterfactual Reasoning.* Poster presented at the 5th European Experimental Philosophy Conference (EXPhi, July), Norwich, UK; the Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP, June), Ithaca, NY; and the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci, August), San Francisco, CA.

Grosu, I., **Le, D.**, & Ganea, P. (2025, July). *Backwards Counterfactuals and the Closest Possible World.* Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci), San Francisco, CA.

Grosu, I., **Le, D.**, & Ganea, P. (2025, June). *Changes to Models of Reality in Backwards Counterfactual Reasoning.* Poster presented at the 51st Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Ithaca, NY.

Student

Le, D., & Mekik, C. (2026, April). *How Search Strategies Explain Directional Asymmetries in Causal Reasoning.* Talk presented at the Psychology Undergraduate Research Community (PURC) Student Symposium, Toronto, ON.

Le, D., Grosu, I., & Ganea, P. (2025, February). *Time's Asymmetry in Counterfactuals.* Talk presented at the Cognitive Science and Artificial Intelligence Student Association (CASA) Undergraduate Conference, Toronto, ON.

Le, D., & Tkachman, O. (2024, March). *Spatial Frames of Reference in Signed Languages.* Talk presented at the Western Interdisciplinary Student Symposium on Language Research (WISSLR), London, ON.

Ongoing Research

Backwards Counterfactual Reasoning in Children and Adults Sep 2024 –
Supervisors: Ioana Grosu & Patricia Ganea, University of Toronto.
Department of Applied Psychology and Human Development.

Modelling Causal Reasoning in a Cognitive Architecture Sep 2024 –
Supervisor: Can Mekik, University of Toronto.
Department of Psychology.

Hierarchical Models of Associative Learning Aug 2024 –
Supervisor: Sara Aronowitz, University of Toronto.
Department of Philosophy.

Labwork

Research Assistant, Cognitive Development Jan 2024 –
PI: Ioana Grosu & Patricia Ganea, University of Toronto.
Language & Learning Lab.

Research Assistant, Psycholinguistics Mar 2023 – Sep 2024
PI: Oksana Tkachman, University of British Columbia.
Language & Learning Lab.

Research Assistant, Morality and Abnormal Psychology Nov 2023 – Jun 2024
PI: Mark Miller, University of Toronto.
Consciousness & Wisdom Studies Lab.

Previous Employment

Childcare Program Assistant, UofT Family Housing Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

Supported Childcare Worker, BGC Canada Jun 2023 – Sep 2023

Camp Program Director, Cadets Canada Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

Awards & Scholarships

($7500) University of Toronto Excellence Award (UTEA-SSH). 2026
University of Toronto Student Leadership Award. 2026
($7500) University of Toronto Excellence Award (UTEA-SSH). 2025
($1500) Victoria College Regents Participation Award. 2025
(Priceless) MAT237 Meme Contest Nominee. x2 2024
($2000) Gyro Club of Nanaimo Jack Ryan Scholarship. 2022
($1250) British Columbia District/Authority Scholarship. 2022
($1250) British Columbia Excellence Scholarship. 2022
($2000) Vancouver Island University Dual Enrollment Scholarship. 2021

Travel Awards

($2250) W. Gordon and Connie Young Marigold Award (CogSci).	2026
($1000) Arriba Travel Award for Cognitive Science (CogSci).	2026
($500) Dr. Roseann Runte Award (CDS).	2026
($1000) Susan Macdonald Award (CogSci).	2025
($250) ASSU Travel Grant (EXPhi).	2025
($150) SPP Travel Award.	2025

Student Affiliations

Editor, Mentis – UofT Cognitive Science Undergraduate Journal	2024 –
Mentor, CURE – Undergraduate Research Student Group	2024 –
Staff Writer, Demo Magazine – Hart House Music Publication	2023 – 2024
Executive Secretary, CASA – CogSci and A.I. Student Association	2024 – 2025
CogSci Course Union Representative, University College Council	2024 – 2025

Skills & Characteristics

Natural Languages:	Fluent: English (native), French. Rudimentary: Vietnamese (first-learned).
Computer Languages:	Proficient: R, Python, Java, HTML/CSS. Rudimentary: JavaScript, C#, C++.
Certifications:	Standard First Aid with CPR-C-AED (St. John Ambulance), Responsible Adult (YMCA, 2023).
Software Tools:	Document-preparation: MS Office, LaTeX (Overleaf/VSCode), Google Workspace. Data-collection: Qualtrics, MTurk, ChildrenHelpingScience, REDCap, jsPsych. Data-processing: RStudio, Pandas+NumPy, JASP. Image-manipulation: Photoshop, Canva. Audio-editing: Ableton Live, Logic, Audacity. Video-editing: Premiere, Final Cut, Animate.
Outside Interests:	Songwriting and role-playing video games.